

Mitra SL

Flexible Working Policy

Scope	This policy aims to encourage staff to consider flexible working arrangements. The organization recognizes that a better work-life balance can improve employee motivation, performance, productivity, and reduce stress whilst ensuring that the business and operational needs of Mitra are maintained. Therefore, the organization wants to support its employees to achieve a better balance between work and their other priorities, such as caring responsibilities, leisure activities, further learning, and other interests. The organization is committed to agreeing any flexible working arrangements, provided that the needs and objectives of both the organization and the employee can be met.	
Policy Measurement	100% adherence to the policy	
Definitions	Company	Mitra Innovation Private Limited - Sri Lanka
	Employees	All full-time employees of the Company: • Probationary or confirmed. • Fixed Term Contract on full time basis. • Internship on full time basis
	Reporting Line	Direct reporting / Immediate Supervisor could be functional / Project Manager
	Flexible working	Flexible working is any type of working arrangement that gives some degree of flexibility to how long, where and when an employee works. The following flexible working options are considered to be the typical arrangements that employees will request but the organization recognizes that there may be alternatives or a combination of options which are suitable to both the organization and the employee: • Compressed hours • Flextime • Home-working • Part-time working
Responsibility	Employee	All employees must apply for the flexible working arrangement requests via email with valid and appropriate reasoning
	Reporting Line	Verify and validate the practicality of the flexible working arrangement request prior to the approval or rejection
	Head of HR	Ensure effective implementation of this policy

Guidelines	
1. Types of flexible working	1.1 Compressed hours: Is where an employee works their usual full-time hours in fewer days by working longer blocks, meaning that there is no reduction in their pay. For example, a 5-day week is compressed into four days. 1.2 Flextime: Employees are given flexibility to start work from 8.30 am to 9.30am and end work from 5.30 pm to 6.30 pm covering the 8 working hours per day (excluding lunch break). 1.3 Home-working: When an employee regularly carries out all, or part of, their duties from home rather than the employer's premises. The organization can consider home-working being an occasional agreed day, a mix of home and office-based work each week or a full-time arrangement. For this to be agreed upon, checks to ensure the working area is secure and does not pose a threat to the Company will be made. 1.4 Part-time working: Covers any arrangement where an employee is contracted to work anything less than typical full-time hours for the type of work in question. For example, an employee who only works Monday to Wednesday. The suitability of posts for part-time work will be stated in any internal or external advertisements.
2. Equipment & Security	- On a case-by-case basis, the Company will determine, with information supplied by the employee and the supervisor, the appropriate equipment needs (including hardware, software, modems, WIFI Routers, phones and data lines and other office equipment) for each Home-working arrangement. HR and ITops will serve as resources in this matter. - Employees are encouraged to use a separate working desk or a separate space for work at home. An employee must ensure that the desk is clear of workstations both at home and office of all personal belongings when they leave. This includes anything that wasn't on the desk when they started using it and applies whenever they leave the desk for an extended period of time. Ideally, no personal effects or sensitive documents should be left unattended at any time (all sensitive documents must be shredded or destroyed immediately). Employees are required to use lockable file cabinets and desks and any other measures to secure the sensitive documents appropriate for the job and environment. Consistent with the organization's expectations of information security for employees working, flextime, home-working, part-time working, term-time working employees using a home wireless network are expected to have.

	○ Changed all factory default passwords in network equipment such as routers and modems being used. ○ Configured to have a dedicated Wi-Fi network for work use free of any personal or IT devices. ○ Configured to use at minimum WPA2 with at least a 12-character PSK password for Wi-Fi access. ○ VPN connectivity to Mitra Corporate network will require multi-factor authentication. ● Employees are restricted from either taking any notes or information on the notepads or paper or taking pictures via phone or camera.
3. The needs of the organization	The organization is committed to providing a range of appropriate working patterns. However, employees and management need to be realistic and to recognize that not all flexible working options will be appropriate for all roles. Where a flexible working arrangement is proposed, the organization will need to take into account a number of criteria including (but not limited to) the following: ● the costs associated with the proposed arrangement. ● the effect of the proposed arrangement on other staff ● the need for, and effect on, supervision ● the existing structure of the team ● the availability of staff resources ● details of the tasks specific to the role ● the workload of the role ● whether it is a request for a reasonable adjustment related to a disability ● health and safety issues Confidentiality issues
4. Eligibility	The organization has taken the view that employees in all areas, and at any level, are entitled to submit a request for flexible working regardless of their length of service.
5. Submitting a flexible working request	An employee is entitled to submit one flexible working request in a 12- month period. All requests must be made via email to the HR team keeping their immediate reporting manager in copy. Any request made must include: ● the date of the request ● Reason for the request ● the changes that the employee is seeking to their terms and conditions. ● the date from when the employee would like the proposed change to come into effect.

	• What effect does the employee think the requested change would have on the organization? • how, in their view, any such effect could be dealt with whether this is a mandatory (Ex - medical reasons) or non-mandatory request • whether a previous application for flexible working has been made • If yes, the dates of any previous applications If an application does not contain all of the required information the HR team will explain to the employee what additional or amended information they need to provide and ask the employee to resubmit the request.
6. Meetings regarding flexible working	Upon receiving a written request for flexible working HR team/ Immediate Supervisor/Practice Head/ Project Manager will usually seek to arrange a meeting with the employee to: • discuss the request • find out more about the proposed working arrangements • how it could be of benefit to both the organization and employee If a meeting is arranged it will be held within 14 days of the organization receiving the request. This time limit may be extended with the agreement of both the employee and HR team/ Immediate Supervisor/Practice Head/ Project Manager. The employee will be given advance notice of the time, date and place of the meeting. If the initial date is problematic, then one further date will be proposed. If a face-to-face meeting is difficult to arrange then, if agreed by the employee and HR team/ Immediate Supervisor/Practice Head/ Project Manager, the meeting will be conducted online. If the employee fails to attend a meeting and then fails to attend a rearranged meeting without good reason, their application will be deemed to have been withdrawn. Where a request can, without further discussion, be approved as stated in the employee's written application a meeting to discuss the request may not be necessary. The employee will be informed of the organization's agreement to the request by a confirmation letter or email as outlined in the section 'Responding to a flexible working request' within 14 days of the organization receiving the request. This time limit may be extended with the agreement of both the employee and HR team/ Immediate Supervisor/Practice Head/ Project Manager.

7. Responding to a flexible working request	The HR team/ Immediate Supervisor/Practice Head/ Project Manager will consider the proposed flexible working arrangements, looking at the potential benefits and adverse effects to the employee and to the organization in implementing the proposed changes. Each request will be considered on a case-by-case basis. Agreeing to one request will not set a precedent or create the right for another employee to be granted a similar change to their working pattern. The employee will be informed in writing of the organization's decision as soon as is reasonably practicable, but no later than 14 days after the meeting. The request may be granted in full, in part or refused. The organization may propose a modified version of the request, the request may be granted on a temporary basis, or the employee may be asked to try the flexible working arrangement for a trial period. If the request is agreed, then the employee will be sent a confirmation letter or email which will include details of the new arrangements. The employee should contact the HR team/ Immediate Supervisor/Practice Head/ Project Manager within 7 days if they wish to discuss the new arrangements further or have any concerns.
8. Right to appeal decision	The employee has the right to appeal the decision if their request is refused or is only agreed in part. The employee may lodge an appeal within 7 days of being notified of a decision on their application. This should be done in writing and clearly state the grounds on which they are appealing. The appeal will be heard within 7 days. The employee will then be informed of the outcome of their appeal within 7 days of the appeal meeting. These time limits may be extended with the agreement of both the employee and HR team/ Immediate Supervisor/Practice Head/ Project Manager.
9. Trialing new working arrangements	Where there is some uncertainty about whether the flexible working arrangement is practicable for an employee and/or the organization a trial period may be agreed. If a trial period is arranged the organization will allow sufficient time for an employee and their manager to implement and become used to the new working practices before taking any decisions on the viability of a new arrangement.
10. Varying an employee's contract	Where flexible working practices are agreed as a permanent change, a variation will need to be made to the employees' contract of employment. A new contract of employment will be sent to the employee within 7 days of the change to the employee's working pattern being agreed. If the employee has any questions or concerns about the new contract of employment, they should contact the HR team to discuss the matter further. When a trial period has been arranged the organization will provide the employee with a document that details their new working pattern and makes clear that it is only a temporary variation to the terms of the employee's contract. The employee will be

	informed in writing of the start and end dates of the trial period (although the organization may reduce or lengthen the trial period where necessary with the agreement of the employee). The organization will reserve the right, at the end of the agreed trial period, to require the employee to revert to their previous working arrangement.
11. Complaints and further information	The organization is strongly opposed to any form of victimization of individuals who work, or request to work under flexible working arrangements. If an employee feels that they have been treated unfairly or are dissatisfied with any stage of the flexible process, they should raise their concerns informally with the HR team/ Immediate Supervisor/Practice Head/ Project Manager. If informal discussions do not resolve the matter to an employee's satisfaction, they should raise a grievance under the organization's grievance procedure. For further information an employee should contact the HR team.

Version Control/Approval

Version Number	Date	Prepared By	Approved By	Reason for New Release
V1.00	21-Mar-2024	Christina Kumar	Irosha Perera	Initial Release for Mitra SL